

Vikram Raghavan

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EXPERIENCE

Meridian Cloud - Principal Engineer

2018 - Present

- Own the multi-region control plane for a platform running 12,000+ compute nodes across 3 continents (99.99% availability SLA).
- Led the service-mesh migration for 80 microservices; tail latency fell 42% and cross-region failover went from 45min to 90s.
- Authored the capacity-planning model that deferred a \$2.1M hardware purchase by 18 months while absorbing 2.4x traffic growth
- Mentored 11 engineers; 4 promoted to senior within two years.
- Drove the incident-review program: repeat incidents fell 70% across two quarters (MTTR 38min to 11min).
- Cut the CI bill 55% (\$380k/yr) by moving 70% of builds to a self-hosted fleet with elastic burst capacity.
- Designed the config-service replacing 40+ static YAML repos, eliminating an entire class of deploy rollbacks.
- Ran the on-call redesign (follow-the-sun), cutting pages/engineer from 14 to 3 per month with no SLA regression.
- Published the internal 'platform golden path' adopted by 23 teams.

Halcyon Systems - Senior Engineer

2014 - 2018

- Built the telemetry ingestion lake (2TB/day) on Kafka + Spark; replaced 6 bespoke pipelines.
- Led Kubernetes adoption from zero to production for the flagship product (40 services).
- Introduced schema-registry governance, ending a year of consumer breakages.
- Automated DR drills; recovery time validated at 17 minutes against a 30-minute objective.
- Reduced the fleet's memory footprint 33% via GC tuning and container right-sizing.

Cirrus Apps - Software Engineer

2011 - 2014

- Shipped the mobile sync engine powering 3 flagship apps.
- Cut cold-start time 61% through lazy init and asset trimming.

PROJECTS

Chaos Lantern - fault-injection harness used by 5 companies

- Simulates zone loss, clock skew, and partition storms against staging clusters.
- Adopted as a release gate by the payments group after catching a quorum bug pre-launch.

Tracepaint - distributed trace visualizer

- Renders 1M-span traces interactively via WebGL sampling.
- Integrated with Jaeger and Tempo backends.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Solutions Architect - Professional (2023)
- CKA - Certified Kubernetes Administrator (2022)

PATENTS & PUBLICATIONS

- US Patent 11,204,556 - adaptive regional request routing (2021)

- 'Failure Modes at Scale', ACM Queue contributor (2022)

OPEN SOURCE & COMMUNITY

- Maintainer, 'routezen' - traffic-shaping library, 1.8k GitHub stars, 300k monthly downloads.
- Organizer, Distributed Systems Meetup (Bengaluru) - 2,400 members, monthly talks.
- Core contributor to 'kvbench'; benchmark suite cited by 3 database papers.

EDUCATION

M.Tech Computer Science, IIT Madras - 2011